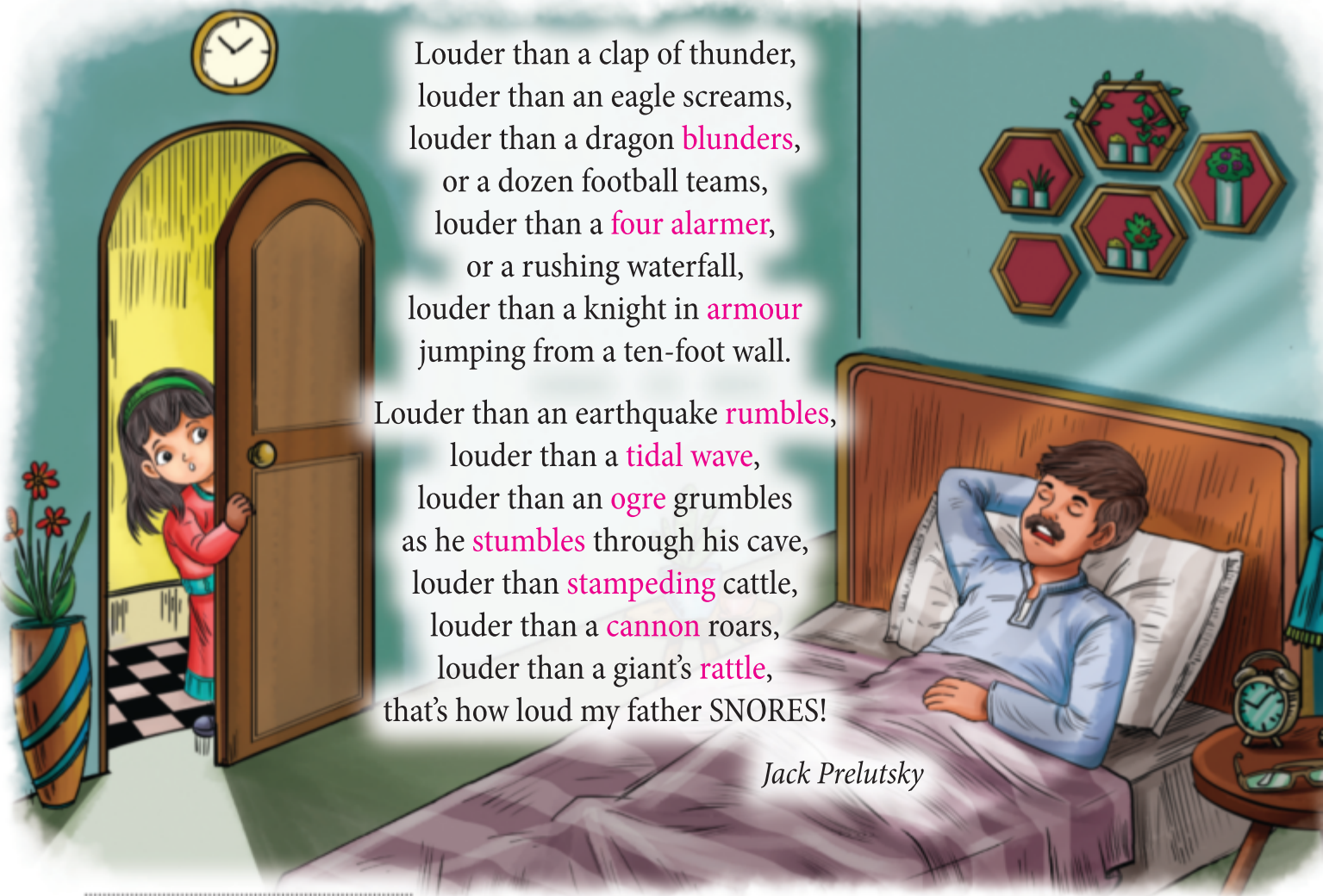


# Louder than a Clap of Thunder



Think of the variety of sounds that you hear in a day. The ring of an alarm clock is loud, but the click of a switch is not. A loud sound can be useful at times, but it can also disturb people. For instance, the loud horn of a bus warns people to move out of its way, but non-stop honking on the roads bothers everyone. Let's read a poem about a very loud sound and find out what it is.



Louder than a clap of thunder,  
louder than an eagle screams,  
louder than a dragon **blunders**,  
or a dozen football teams,  
louder than a **four alarmer**,  
or a rushing waterfall,  
louder than a knight in **armour**  
jumping from a ten-foot wall.

Louder than an earthquake **rumbles**,  
louder than a **tidal wave**,  
louder than an **ogre** grumbles  
as he **stumbles** through his cave,  
louder than **stampeding** cattle,  
louder than a **cannon** roars,  
louder than a giant's **rattle**,  
that's how loud my father SNORES!

*Jack Prelutsky*

**blunders:** moves in a clumsy manner      **four alarmer:** alarms at a fire station—the bigger the fire, the more the alarms  
**armour:** metal covering that people wore long ago, while fighting      **rumbles:** makes a long deep sound  
**tidal wave:** a large sea wave that is formed during a bad storm      **ogre:** a giant creature found in fairy tales  
**stumbles:** hits one's foot against something and almost falls      **stampeding:** (here) a big group of animals running in fear  
**cannon:** a large gun placed on wheels that shoots big bullets that are shaped like balls      **rattle:** the noise of things hitting against each other

**Jack Prelutsky** (born in 1940) is an American poet who has published more than fifty collections of poems, including *A Pizza the Size of the Sun* and *Be Glad Your Nose Is on Your Face: And Other Poems*. He is renowned for his witty, humorous poems that are well loved by children and adults alike.

**In this section, we will:**

- identify and interpret the central ideas of a poem.
- recognize relevant details to answer questions based on the poem. (C-2.1, C-2.2)

## Make connections

Answer the following questions based on the poem.

1. Draw lines to match the pictures to the sounds or noisy movements described in the poem.



grumbles  
rushing  
screams  
clap  
blunders  
roars



2. Read these lines and answer the questions that follow.

- a. *louder than an ogre grumbles  
as he stumbles through his cave,  
louder than stampeding cattle,*
  - i. Which two words in these lines describe movements?
  - ii. Which word best describes the ogre: 'clumsy' or 'sure-footed'?
  - iii. Which other word in the stanza can be considered a synonym for 'giant'?
- b. *louder than a cannon roars,  
louder than a giant's rattle,  
that's how loud my father SNORES!*
  - i. What are the different sounds described in these lines?
  - ii. Why did the poet list these sounds?
  - iii. Circle the three words in the help box below that rhyme most closely with 'rattle'.

bottle      battle      kettle      prattle      skittle      cattle

- Of all the sounds listed in the poem, which one do you think would be the loudest? Give reasons for your answer.
- What do you think makes this poem humorous?

## Appreciation



### Hyperbole

Read the given lines.

- louder than a knight in armour  
jumping from a ten-foot wall

These lines are examples of **exaggeration**.

In fact, the entire poem is **hyperbolic**!

Hyperbole is pronounced as *hy-per-buh-lee*.

**Exaggeration** means to show something as being louder, larger, better or more important than it actually is.

In this section, we will:

- learn to identify and use hyperbole.
  - write a poem using hyperbole.
- (C-2.1, C-2.2, C-3.3)

**Hyperbole** is the use of exaggeration while speaking or writing.

- Let us try using hyperbole to play a question-and-answer game. Your teacher will say a statement aloud. One of you should ask a question based on it and the teacher will answer using hyperbole. Then, all of you can take turns to make statements and use hyperbole in your answers. Have fun!

Examples: Teacher: My brother is tall.

Class: How tall is he?

Teacher: He is taller than a mountain peak.

Student 1: Kairav runs very fast.

Class: How fast is he?

Student 1: He is faster than a bolt of lightning streaking across the sky.

My backpack weighs a ton!



- Now, try writing some hyperboles of your own (some examples have been given in *italics*). Use your imagination and write—it does not matter if your lines do not rhyme.

Softer than \_\_\_\_\_ (a sound from nature: *a gentle breeze*),

Softer than \_\_\_\_\_ (a sound made by an animal: *an ant's tiny sneeze*),

Softer than \_\_\_\_\_ (a sound from an imaginary creature or a character from a book or TV programme: *a unicorn's murmur*),

or a dozen \_\_\_\_\_ (sounds made by people: *sighs*),

Softer than \_\_\_\_\_ (a person doing work: *a librarian flipping books*),

That's how softly my friend speaks!